

Feedback on COMP40018A Exam (paper 1)

Question 1

This year's exam has been of average difficulty with respect to previous years, but had certain parts that a lot of students found really difficult. The main point I would like to make is that many students showed poor time management. Very few students answered all the parts, thereby not giving the opportunity to gain marks, and many spent too much time (and paper) answering some parts. Please bear in mind that we cannot give any marks to an empty answer, and that spending a lot of time on one part cannot compensate for not answering another.

Question 1 - Average performance: B

1a) This part asked for some set construction, testing the understanding of the basic set operations; most students got this right. Average score was 93%.

1b) This was a variant of an exercise in the notes; most students got this right. Although the questions explicitly stated "You do not need to give a formal proof", many students did, and wrote down answers that were too long. Average score was 77%.

1c) This part was a variant of a question that appeared in the coursework, and was the lowest scoring part of the exam, mainly because many did not see that $\{0\}$ is in V as well. Only 86% attempted this part, and the average score for those who attempted was 58%.

1d) This was an exercise on whether or not sets of pairs were functions, and had very mixed results. Almost all students attempted this, with an average result of 62%.

1e) This part asked to show that a set was countable and another was not; 20% of students skipped this part, and most who attempted it had difficulty writing a complete answer, attempting a listing diagram that was not well defined or correct. The average score for those who attempted this part was 65%.

Question 2

Details to follow.

Question 2 - Average performance: C

2a.i) To follow.

2a.ii) To follow.

2a.iii) To follow.

2b.i) To follow.

2b.ii) To follow.